

Payment of salaries and wages

Human Resources Policy C13 (QH-POL-188)

Purpose

This policy outlines Queensland Health (the department and hospital and health services) and its employees' responsibilities in the management of forms and processes related to payment of salary, wages and pay amendments.

Application

This policy applies to all employees of the Department of Health and Health Service Employees who are paid through the Queensland Health payroll system. This policy does not apply to Queensland Ambulance Service employees paid under separate payroll systems.

Policy

1 Principles

The following principles apply to the payment of salary and wages, and related processes:

- **Timeliness:** Salaries and wages must be processed within the timeframes prescribed by the *Industrial Relations Act 2016*, Queensland Government Directives (including Public Sector Commission (PSC) and Minister for Industrial Relations Directives), legislation, and certified agreements.
- **Transparency and accuracy:** Employees, line managers, and pay support staff must have access to guidelines and support to fulfill their responsibilities.
- **Compliance:** All payments, deductions, and recovery processes must comply with legislation, Health Employment Directives, Queensland government Directives, policies, and certified agreements. Payroll processes will be subject to regular audits for compliance and continuous improvement.

2 Payment of salary and wages

The Queensland Health fortnightly pay period commences on a Monday and concludes on the Sunday at the end of the fortnight. Payments to employees are made in arrears with payment being made by electronic funds transfer to the employee's nominated financial institution.

The PSC *Directive 17/13 Pay Date for Employees of Queensland Health* prescribes that the pay date for employees of Queensland Health will be no later than ten calendar days after the completion of the fortnightly pay period.

Employees will receive a payslip available electronically in *myHR* prior to pay day Wednesday. The pay advice explains how an employee's pay amount has been calculated in terms of:

- gross and net pay
- hours and dates worked (including adjustments from previous pay periods if applicable)
- specific deductions including mandatory deductions (e.g. taxation)
- voluntary deductions (e.g. salary sacrifice)
- employer superannuation contributions
- leave taken
- allowance payments, if applicable.

Employees should review their payslip on *myHR* within two days of the payslip being made available. Should an employee identify they have been paid incorrectly, the employee is to raise the error with their line manager or through *myHR* as soon as possible.

Line managers, when notified by an employee of an incorrect wage payment, must take all steps to rectify the error including but not limited to:

- assisting the employee
- preparing and submitting further forms if required
- liaising with Payroll to correct the error, where appropriate.

Line managers must ensure their team's human resource and payroll information is up to date and actioned in a timely manner and within specified timeframes, where applicable.

3 Employees in multiple engagements

Employees who work simultaneously in multiple engagements across Queensland Health, i.e. aggregate or concurrent employment arrangements, are to refer to the Guideline for Management of aggregate and concurrent employment for details regarding the processing of salary, wages and payroll.

4 Payroll and Human Resource form management

Queensland Health uses a range of different electronic forms to enable timely and accurate payment of employee pay. Queensland Health payroll systems enable Queensland Health to meet its statutory obligations including maintaining an employee register, record of calculation of an employee's pay and payment of wages. Where a payroll issue cannot be resolved between the employee and line manager, either the employee or line manager can escalate the issue to Payroll Services.

4.1 Responsibilities of employees

Employees must submit complete, accurate and timely requests or amendments via *myHR* or Infor WFM (where applicable) within 24 hours or as soon as reasonably

practicable as it relates to time and attendance. For example, in the case of unplanned leave, the form must be submitted on the employee's first day back to work, this would generally be considered as soon as reasonably practicable. Should this delay result in incorrect payment for an employee, the line manager must discuss with the employee corrective action to be undertaken (e.g. submission of a leave form).

Employees must submit or approve all other applications (e.g. long service leave applications, professional development leave requests, movement forms) prior to commencement of the relevant planned leave or change in work arrangement.

Employees must use the Employee Self Service menu in *myHR* to update all changes to personal details immediately.

4.2 Responsibilities of line managers

Line managers must ensure employees have adequate time within their rostered period of work to submit payroll forms and review their roster.

All planned rosters must be approved by an employee and line manager prior to being submitted for processing. Evidence of roster approval must be retained in accordance with local requirements.

Line managers, upon receipt of a *myHR* form or application, must action this form within two days or prior to 5pm Monday following the roster period end date, whichever is sooner. All roster variations must be submitted at the end of the affected shift through a daily staffing variance (DSVF) or attendance variation and allowance claim (AVAC) form, or through the IWFM rostering solution (where applicable). Where this is not possible, the line manager must submit the roster variation the next business day or within 24 hours of the roster period end date, whichever is sooner.

Line managers should ensure employees are recorded in the payroll system in accordance with the position and work unit in which they are actually performing their work duties. It is not acceptable to simply place employees "against" positions they are not actually working in. For rotations, placements, secondments a "seconded out" position may be used for example where the employee is working in an external entity.

Line managers must ensure all employees' positions are correctly flagged for Fringe Benefit Tax (FBT) in the payroll system, i.e. consistent with the table of Designated Eligible Business Areas in the Public Hospital FBT Exemption Cap and Salary Packaging Arrangements Finance Practice Statement.

FBT exemption cap eligible business units failing to meet these requirements may jeopardise their ongoing access to the FBT cap (which is not an employee entitlement).

For those employees on long-term leave without pay or employees on WorkCover or Income Protection, line managers are required to ensure compliance with *HR Policy G4 Absence management* and related guidelines.

4.3 Non-compliance by an employee or line manager

Non-compliance by an employee or line manager with submission of timely and accurate payroll forms may lead to payment delays and inaccuracies in wage calculation.

Where an employee or line manager has not made reasonable efforts to comply with this Policy, and non-compliance is ongoing, the matter may be referred to the local Human Resources team for advice. The relevant delegate may consider managing the matter under the Positive Performance Management process, as outlined in *Human Resources Policy G9 – Positive Performance Management* for further ongoing non-compliance.

5 Submission timeframes

The submission of forms must be complete, accurate and timely. The form submission timings in this section are separate from any required notice periods for taking leave, which are specific in the relevant HR Policy. Notice periods support operational planning with submission timeframes supporting pay accuracy, processing, and data integrity.

Form type	Submission deadline	Approval requirement	Notes
Leave forms	Action within two days or prior to 5pm Monday following the roster period end date, whichever is sooner	Line manager with HR delegation	Ensure supporting documentation is attached.
Overtime	Pre-approved or within three days of the overtime being performed	Line manager with HR delegation	Justification required for retrospective approvals.
Roster variations	By the end of the affected shift or next business day	Line manager	Must use Daily Staffing Variance Form (DSVF) or Attendance Variation and Allowance Claim (AVAC)
Ad hoc requests	5:00 PM on pay day Wednesday		Include relevant Process Reference Number (PRN).

The submission of rostering changes for organisational units on IWFM must be complete, accurate and timely within the rostering cutoff.

IWFM rostering change	Submission deadline	Approval requirement	Notes
Leave forms	Action within two days or prior to 5pm Tuesday following the roster period end date, whichever is sooner	Line manager with HR delegation	Ensure supporting documentation is attached.

Roster variations including emergent leave, overtime, on-call / recalls	By the end of the affected shift or next business day.	Line manager with HR delegations must be approved in the Supervisor Approval Worksheet by 5pm Tuesday following the roster cutoff.	Must use Daily Staffing or other relevant IWFM electronic rostering process. Justification must be provided for retrospective overtime approvals.
Ad hoc requests	5:00 PM on pay day Wednesday		Include relevant Process Reference Number (PRN).

6 Line managers signing on behalf of employees

Line managers and employees should ensure that employees complete and sign forms submitted to *myHR*. To ensure access to entitlements and/or correct pay to employees line managers may submit leave requests on behalf of employees provided:

- The employee's request for leave is documented in writing (e.g. email, text message, or hard copy); and
- Any required supporting documents (e.g. employee's written request for leave, medical certificates for sick leave) are sourced and retained.

For leave types requiring mutual agreement (e.g. annual or long service leave), line managers must not unilaterally place employees on leave, unless permitted to do so under an industrial instrument or the *Industrial Relations Act 2016*. An employee's written consent must be retained by the line manager. Line managers are required to upload relevant supporting documents to *myHR* to maintain an accurate record of the request.

Where an employee's consent is required to vary an employee's employment terms*, and to avoid any financial disadvantage to an employee, line managers may submit *myHR* forms provided:

- the form is approved by the employee before submission to *myHR*
- the supervisor retains a copy of the employee's written consent to the form being submitted
- the signed form is obtained and uploaded to *myHR* as soon as possible noting the processing reference number.

*For the purposes of this paragraph, employment terms may include the employment status or type (e.g. permanent or part-time).

7 Industrial disputes

If the outcome of an industrial dispute results in changing employee payments, the line manager, in consultation with their local Human Resources team is to seek advice from Payroll Services and where appropriate from legal teams, and upon agreement, determine the most appropriate approach to ensuring employees are paid correctly. For

example, depending on the number of impacted employees, the most appropriate approach could be through a facilitated submission with the line manager and where required, delegate's approval.

8 Ad hoc payment process

The ad hoc payments process enables employees to request a payment that was missed or requires correction outside of the regular pay day schedule without waiting for the next pay cycle. The ad hoc payment process requires:

1. Employees should review their payslip, generally available from each Monday of pay week, via *myHR* to ensure their pay is accurate.
2. If any pay discrepancies are identified, employees must promptly inform their line manager and submit a corrective payroll form, if this has not already occurred.
3. Line managers and employees are responsible for submitting payroll forms as soon as possible.
4. The employee can request an ad hoc payment through:
 - lodgement of the ad hoc payment request in *myHR*
 - contacting Payroll Services
 - in the event an employee is unable to access *myHR* or contact Payroll Services, the line manager can request an ad hoc payment on their behalf.
5. To enable prompt receipt of the payment, ad hoc payment requests should be lodged by 5pm payday Wednesday to ensure payment is received before the next regular pay day schedule.
6. Due to Australian Taxation Office reporting requirements, it is acknowledged that at end of financial year, ad hoc payments may be delayed as advised through state-wide communications of a short block-out period.

9 Employee requested review of pay entitlements

When an employee identifies that a potential underpayment (or overpayment) occurred prior to their most recent pay, or considers their pay may be continuously incorrect, the employee is to promptly advise their line manager regarding incorrect wage payments in the first instance. Additional support to employees and line managers is available through the local Payroll and Human Resources teams.

If an overpayment occurs, refer to *HR Policy C48 – Overpayments and loans*.

10 Conversion of annual amounts to fortnightly equivalents

Annual salaries included in Awards or Certified Agreements are for information purposes only. Payment is to be made in accordance with the fortnightly salaries shown.

Annual allowances are converted to a fortnightly equivalent by dividing the amount by 26.0892857142.

Legislation and related documents

- Public Sector Act 2022
- Public Sector Regulation 2022

- Industrial Relations Act 2016
- PSC Directive 17/13 Pay Date for Employees of Queensland Health
- HR Policy C48 – Overpayments and loans (QH-POL-184)
- HR Policy C60 – Overtime (QH-POL-185)
- HR Policy C47 – Aggregate and concurrent employment (QH-POL-301)
- Guideline for Management of aggregate and concurrent employment (QH-GDL-301-1)
- Human Resources Policy G9 – Positive Performance Management

Delegation

The delegate is as listed in the relevant HR Delegations Manual and the Expenditure Delegation Manual, as amended from time to time.

Definitions

Term	Definition
Ad hoc payments	An ad hoc payment is a special payment option available for Queensland Health employees if they identify they are missing pay in the most recent prior pay period, and seek the payment prior to the next pay day. Ad hoc payment process is not to be used for payment of missed pay for extended periods. Refer to section 9: Employee requested wage review, for further information on continuous incorrect pay.
Payroll form	Document or digital template/system used to record and process employee remuneration for a given pay period.
Queensland Health	Queensland Health includes all divisions of the Department of Health and all Hospital and Health Services.

History

Date	Policy change
23 June 2025	Modernisation of the policy by clarifying roles and responsibilities, introducing clear submission timeframes for payroll actions, and removing payroll deduction governance to be a guideline and clarifying actions for signing on behalf of employees.
June 2020	Policy application amended as a result of changes to the Hospital and Health Boards (Changes to Prescribed Services) Amendment Regulation 2019.

Date	Policy change
June 2019	Policy formatted as part of the HR Policy review Policy amended to: • update references and naming conventions • include reference to aggregate and concurrent employment arrangements • clarify pay period and pay day • clarify recovery of unpaid wages timeframe • move information regarding use of attendance variation and allowance claim forms from Attachment One to the body of the policy • clarify the requirement for the delegate to have received appropriate supplementary documentation (e.g. medical certificate) when leave is included on an AVAC (section 4) • include payroll deductions governance and operating principles as outlined in Attachment One
May 2014	• Policy reviewed as part of the Queensland Ambulance Service (QAS) HR Policy Integration project. • Policy not applicable to QAS employees.
September 2013	• Policy formatted as part of the HR Policy Simplification project. • Deletion of clause 7.2 Payroll Deductions – Union Fees/Subscriptions in line with amendments to the <i>Industrial Relations Act 1999</i>
February 2013	• Amended section 7.3 to include other types of leave that require supplementary documentation.
October 2012	• Amended to add sections 7.3, 7.4 and 7.5 to reflect changes to payroll processing requirements. • Amended to update references.
July 2008	• Amended to reflect <i>Public Service Act 2008</i>
June 2008	• Developed as a result of the HR Policy Consolidation Project
Previous	• IRM 5.2 Conversions of Annual Amounts to Fortnightly Equivalents • IRM 5.3 Payroll Deductions – Union Fees/Subscriptions